HEALTHCARE INTELLIGENCE · FROM PUBLIC SOURCES NO. 1

VIGILLINE DAILY

MONDAY, 26 OCTOBER 2026 BENGALURU COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Amgen's Imdelltra cuts risk of death by 58% in first-line small cell lung cancer

A Phase 3 regimen combining Imdelltra with Imfinzi more than halved the risk of death versus Imfinzi alone in the maintenance setting — the readout ESMO delegates came to Madrid for.

Amgen reported at ESMO 2026 that Imdelltra, given with AstraZeneca's Imfinzi, reduced the risk of dying by 58% compared with Imfinzi alone in the first-line maintenance treatment of extensive-stage small cell lung cancer. The trial is Phase 3 and the comparison is against the current standard of care in that setting, not against placebo.

Small cell lung cancer has been the disease where immunotherapy delivered modest gains and then stalled. A 58% reduction in the risk of death, if it holds through maturity and survives regulatory review, is a larger effect than the class has produced in this line — which is why the readout dominated the first two days of the congress.

Two caveats belong beside the number. The data are a conference presentation, not a peer-reviewed publication, and the full survival curves, subgroup behaviour and toxicity profile will decide how the regimen is used. Amgen has not stated a filing date in the material reviewed here. VigilLine will follow the manuscript and the label.

The commercial question is equally live: Imdelltra is a bispecific built to be given with a checkpoint inhibitor, so the regimen binds Amgen's asset to AstraZeneca's franchise in exactly the line where AstraZeneca already sells Imfinzi. That is a partnership structure worth watching as much as the hazard ratio.

IN NUMBERS

58%

reduction in risk of death, Imdelltra + Imfinzi vs Imfinzi, first-line maintenance SCLC

44%

risk-of-death reduction for Roche's KRAS G12C inhibitor in a head-to-head lung trial

19,703

adults in the ICMR tribal kidney study across 53 communities

ALSO TODAY

ESMO26 draws close to 40,000 delegates to Madrid over five days
ENDPOINTS NEWS

AstraZeneca eyes Keytruda's Padcev position; Lilly's ADC takes on Elahere
ENDPOINTS NEWS

US Treasury proposal could curb Chinese investment in biotech
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BRIEFS

Roche's KRAS G12C inhibitor cuts death risk 44% in head-to-head lung trial

Roche's next-generation KRAS G12C inhibitor reduced the risk of death by 44% versus rival drugs of the same class in previously treated mutant non-small cell lung cancer, detailed at ESMO26. Head-to-head data in this class have been scarce; a 44% margin, if replicated, resets the comparator for every KRAS programme behind it.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

FDA approves drug for advanced pancreatic cancer

The FDA approved a therapy for advanced pancreatic cancer, according to ABC News. Pancreatic cancer has one of the thinnest treatment menus of any solid tumour, so each approval changes the standard of care rather than adding to it. Full label terms were not in the source reviewed.

ABC NEWS VIA GOOGLE NEWS

One in four tribal adults in Odisha has impaired kidney function

An ICMR study in the October 2026 Indian Journal of Medical Research analysed 19,703 adults across 53 tribal communities in 14 districts and found roughly one in four with impaired kidney function. The finding matters for screening policy: kidney disease at that prevalence is invisible until dialysis, and tribal populations are rarely in the denominator.

ET HEALTHWORLD · ICMR

AIIMS oncologists name 'VIP culture' as a patient-safety problem

In an opinion paper in Oncology Reviews, surgical oncologists describe how pressure from influential patients and their families distorts triage, consent and ward decisions. The argument is not about manners: it is that preferential access changes clinical outcomes for everyone else in the queue.

ET HEALTHWORLD · AIIMS

Healthcare GCCs projected to add 67,000 jobs in 2026

Quess Corp's India Healthcare GCC Outlook 2026 projects about 67,000 openings, driven by mid-career hires rather than entry-level volume. For service providers, the buyer is shifting from hospital IT to captive centres with their own budgets.

ET HEALTHWORLD · QUESS CORP

US Treasury proposal could curb Chinese investment in biotech

A Treasury proposal under discussion would restrict US capital from flowing into Chinese biotech assets. Licensing deals that have supplied Western pipelines with China-derived molecules would face a slower route, which changes diligence timelines for every BD team in the sector.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

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